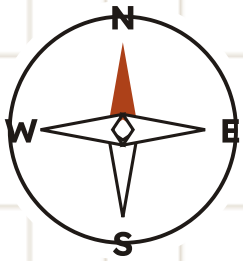
My map

10 POINTS

Draw your home, your garden or a place you know well, as a bird would see it from above. Use the same little symbol every time you draw the same kind of thing, then explain each symbol in the key.

A map of _____



Key

☐ _____ ☐ _____

☐ _____ ☐ _____

☐ _____ ☐ _____

Name _____ Date _____

Map symbols to copy

10 POINTS

A symbol is a tiny, simple drawing that stands for a real thing. Copy the ones you need, or invent your own in the empty boxes.

 tree	 bush	 flowers	 pond
 path	 fence	 gate	 door
 window	 table	 bed	 sofa
 TV	 bath	 toilet	 cooker
 fridge	 stairs	 car	 shed
 swing	 trampoline	 bin	 post box
 church	 school	 shop	 hill
my own symbol	my own symbol	my own symbol	my own symbol

Name _____ Date _____

How to make a map

10 POINTS

1. Walk around it

Walk round the place with a grown-up. Look at what is where: what is next to what, and what is far apart.

2. Choose what to show

Pick 6 to 10 important things: doors, trees, the pond, the shed, your bed. A map does not need everything.

3. Draw the outline from above

Imagine you are a bird looking straight down. Draw the edge of the room or garden first, then the big things inside it.

4. Add symbols

Use a small, simple symbol for each thing. Use the same symbol every time you draw a tree, a door or a window.

5. Make the key

In the key, draw each symbol once and write what it means. A map reader uses the key to understand your map.

6. Compass and title

Add a compass with N for north at the top, and a title such as "A map of my garden". Done!

What is a bird's-eye view?



from the side:
a table has legs

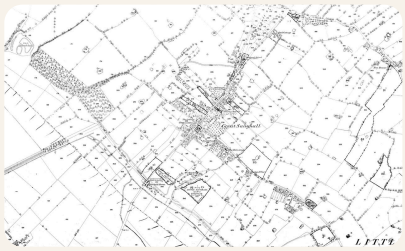


from above:
a rectangle

Maps are drawn from above, like a bird or a drone would see things. The top of a table is a rectangle; a round tree is a circle; a path is a wiggly line.

A Victorian map fact

While Queen Victoria was on the throne, the Ordnance Survey mapped every county of Britain in enormous detail. Cheshire was surveyed between 1870 and 1875, so every field, church, canal and railway around Wrenbury was drawn on a map with a key to the symbols, just like yours. This one shows Chester.



A Victorian Ordnance Survey map of Chester · Ordnance Survey (British History Online), 1871 to 1891, Public domain, via Wikimedia Commons

Practice patch

Try drawing your bedroom from above here first. Where is the door? Where is the window? Where is your bed?

Name _____ Date _____